

ST5209/X Assignment 5

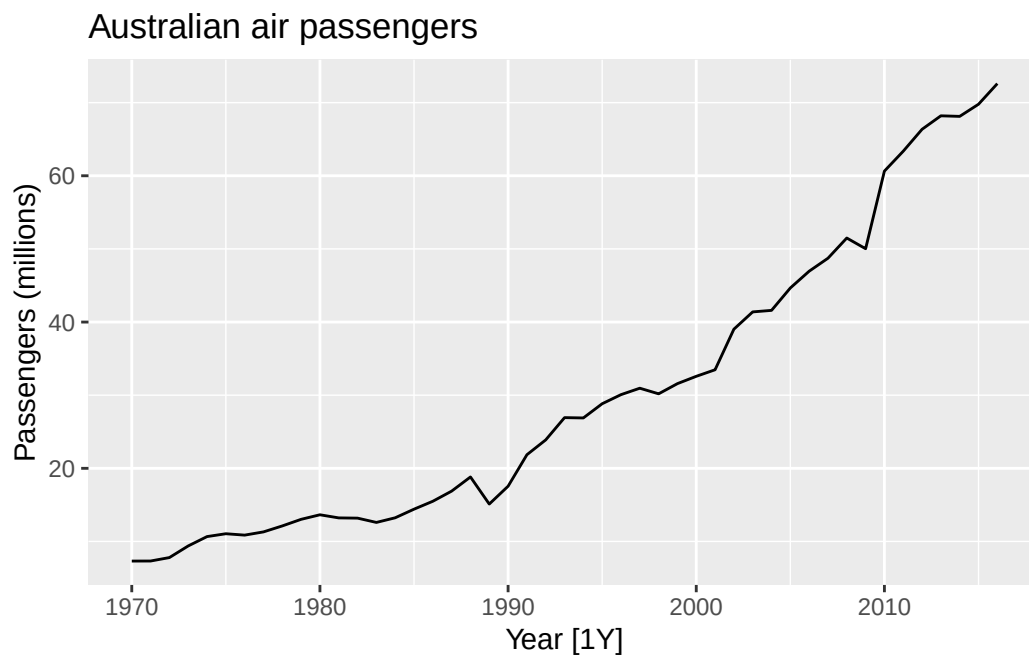
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Submission

1. Render the document to get a .pdf printout.
2. Submit both the .qmd and .pdf files to Canvas.

1. Modeling with ARIMA (Q9.7 in Hyndman & Athanasopoulos)

```
aus_airpassengers |> autoplot(Passengers) +  
  labs(title = "Australian air passengers", y = "Passengers (millions)")
```



- a. Fit an ARIMA model with `ARIMA()`.

```
fit_auto <- aus_airpassengers |>
  model(arima = ARIMA(Passengers ~ 0 + pdq(0, 2, 1)))
report(fit_auto)
```

Series: Passengers
Model: ARIMA(0,2,1)

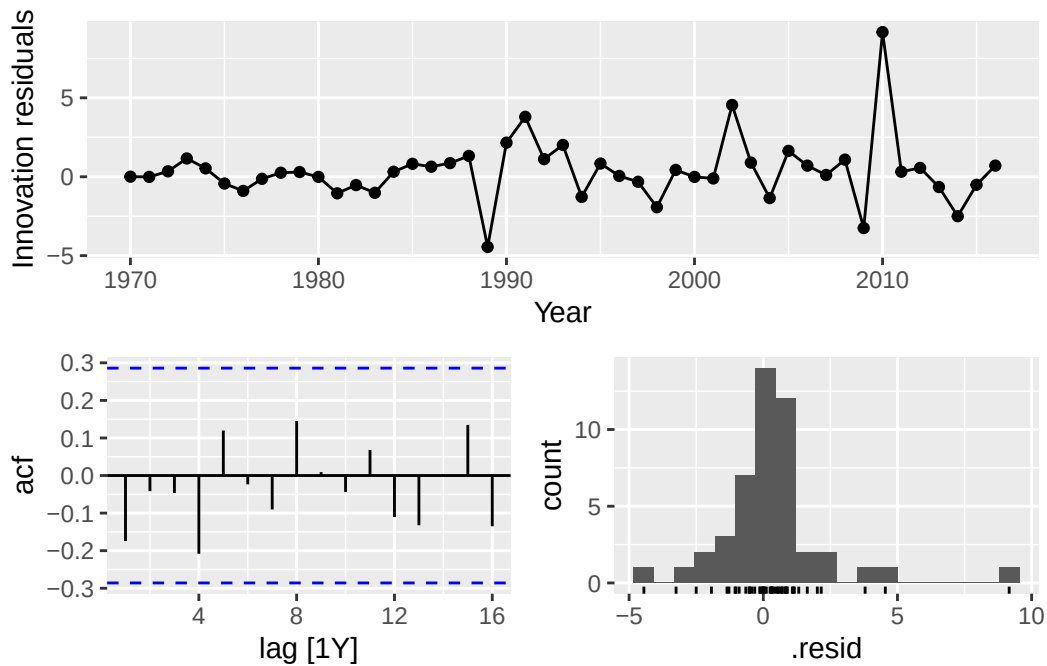
Coefficients:
ma1
-0.8963
s.e. 0.0594

sigma^2 estimated as 4.308: log likelihood=-97.02
AIC=198.04 AICc=198.32 BIC=201.65

The selected model is **ARIMA(0, 2, 1)** (no constant). The estimated MA(1) coefficient is $\hat{\theta}_1 = -0.8963$ (s.e. 0.0594), $\hat{\sigma}^2 = 4.308$, with log-likelihood -97.02 , AIC = 198.04, AICc = 198.32, BIC = 201.65.

Residual diagnostics.

```
fit_auto |> gg_tsresiduals()
```



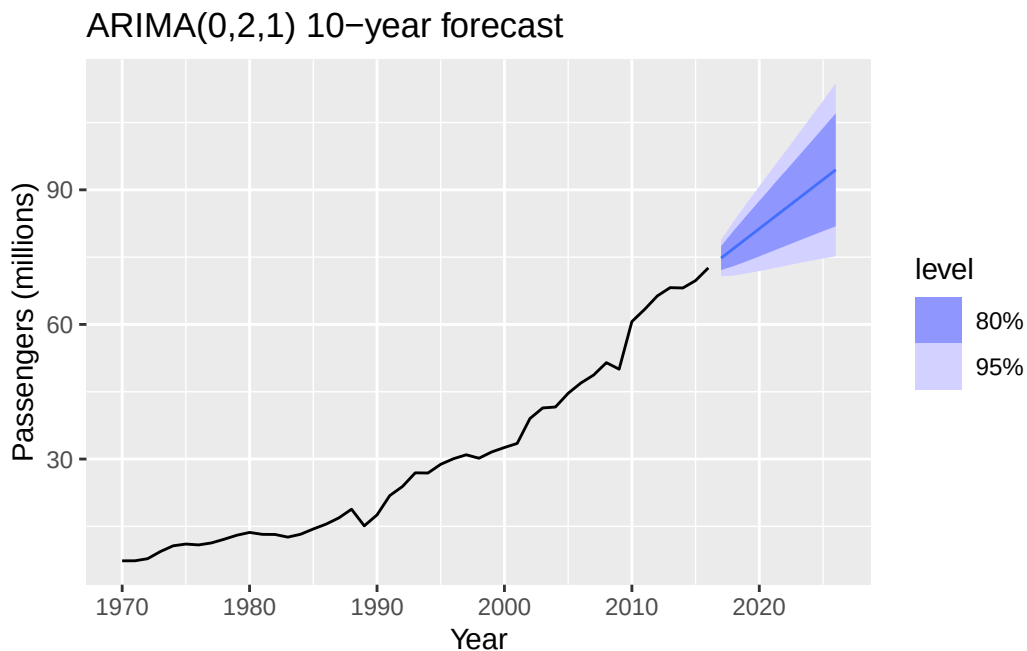
```
fit_auto |> augment() |> features(.innov, ljung_box, lag = 10, dof = 1)
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 3
  .model lb_stat lb_pvalue
  <chr>    <dbl>    <dbl>
1 arima      6.70      0.669
```

The residual ACF spikes all sit inside the significance bands (largest $|\hat{\rho}| \approx 0.21$ at lag 4, within $\pm 2/\sqrt{47} \approx \pm 0.29$), the residual histogram looks roughly symmetric, and the Ljung–Box test at lag 10 (with $\text{dof} = 1$) gives $Q^* = 6.70$ and $p = 0.669$. We do not reject the white-noise null, so the residuals are consistent with white noise.

Forecasts for the next 10 years.

```
fit_auto |>
  forecast(h = 10) |>
  autoplot(aus_airpassengers) +
  labs(title = "ARIMA(0,2,1) 10-year forecast", y = "Passengers (millions)")
```



The point forecasts from 2017 to 2026 are approximately 74.8, 77.0, 79.2, 81.3, 83.5, 85.7, 87.9, 90.1, 92.3, 94.5 (in millions) — a nearly linear extrapolation with slope ≈ 2.2 per year.

b. Backshift operator form.

For ARIMA(0, 2, 1), the model is $(1 - B)^2 X_t = (1 + \theta_1 B) W_t$. Substituting $\hat{\theta}_1 = -0.8963$,

$$(1 - B)^2 X_t = (1 - 0.8963 B) W_t, \quad W_t \sim WN(0, 4.308).$$

c. **ARIMA(0, 1, 0) with drift.**

```
fit_c <- aus_airpassengers |>
  model(arima = ARIMA(Passengers ~ 1 + pdq(0, 1, 0)))
report(fit_c)
```

Series: Passengers

Model: ARIMA(0,1,0) w/ drift

Coefficients:

constant

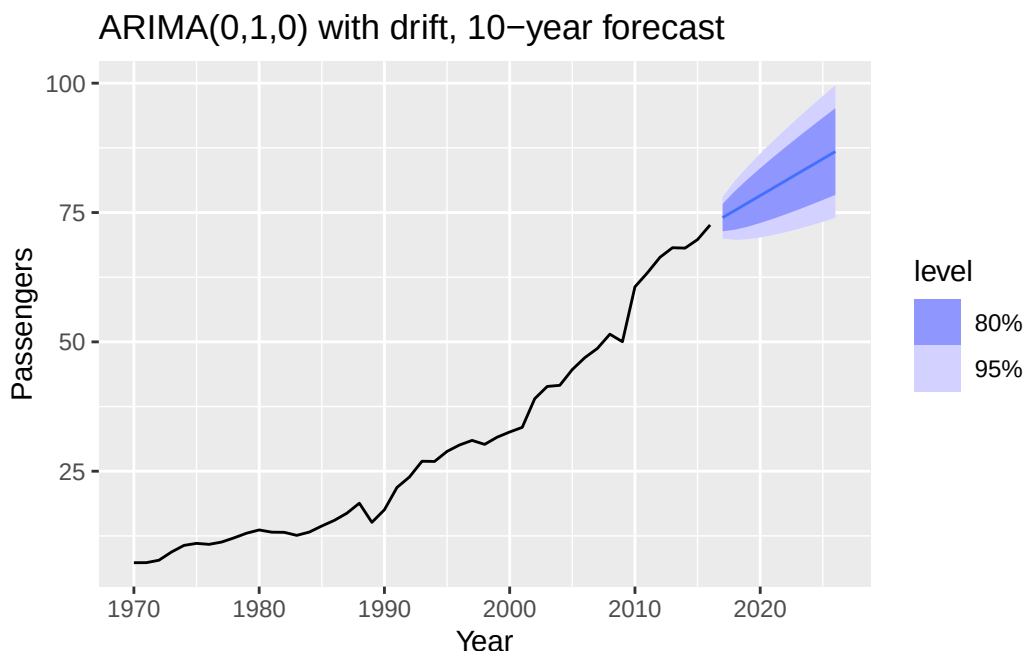
1.4191

s.e. 0.3014

sigma^2 estimated as 4.271: log likelihood=-98.16

AIC=200.31 AICc=200.59 BIC=203.97

```
fit_c |>
  forecast(h = 10) |>
  autoplot(aus_airpassengers) +
  labs(title = "ARIMA(0,1,0) with drift, 10-year forecast")
```



This is a random walk with drift $\hat{c} = 1.4191$ per year (s.e. 0.3014, $\hat{\sigma}^2 = 4.271$, $\text{AICc} = 200.59$). The point forecasts are 74.0, 75.4, 76.9, 78.3, 79.7, 81.1, 82.5, 84.0, 85.4, 86.8 — a straight line with slope $\hat{c} = 1.4191$. Compared with part (a), both give straight-line forecasts, but the slope here (1.42) is smaller than that from ARIMA(0,2,1) (≈ 2.2). Formally, ARIMA(0,2,1) implies that the first differences follow an MA(1), so the forecast extrapolates the *recent* change in slope rather than a fixed drift, which better captures the steepening growth near the end of the series.

d. **ARIMA(2, 1, 2) with drift.**

```
fit_d <- aus_airpassengers |>
  model(arima = ARIMA(Passengers ~ 1 + pdq(2, 1, 2)))
report(fit_d)
```

Series: Passengers

Model: ARIMA(2,1,2) w/ drift

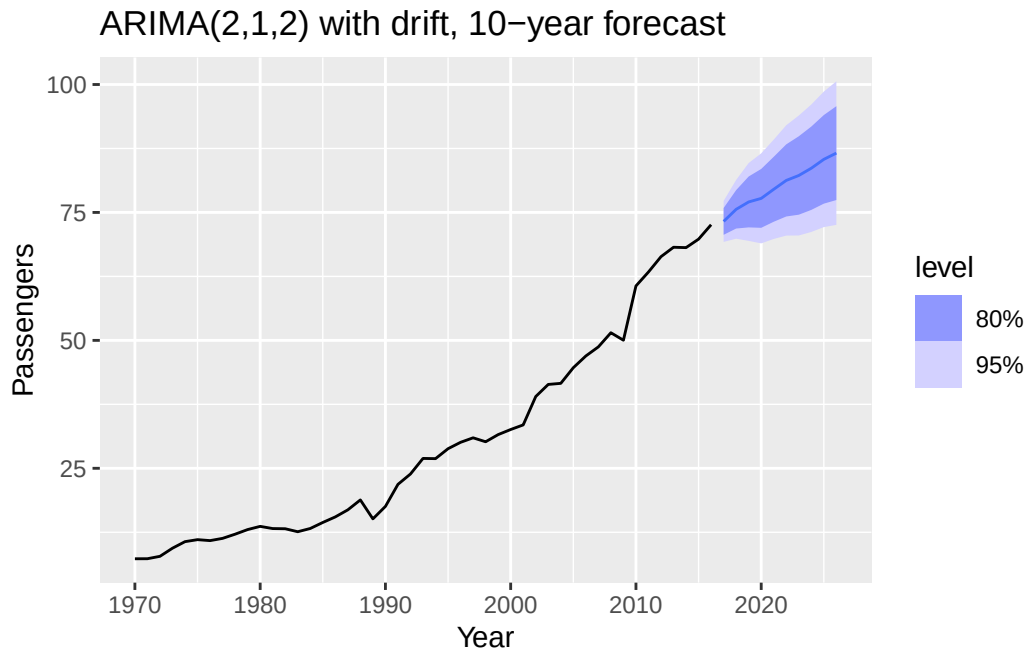
Coefficients:

	ar1	ar2	ma1	ma2	constant
	-0.5518	-0.7327	0.5895	1.0000	3.2216
s.e.	0.1684	0.1224	0.0916	0.1008	0.7224

sigma² estimated as 4.031: log likelihood=-96.23

AIC=204.46 AICc=206.61 BIC=215.43

```
fit_d |>
  forecast(h = 10) |>
  autoplot(aus_airpassengers) +
  labs(title = "ARIMA(2,1,2) with drift, 10-year forecast")
```



The fit gives $\hat{\phi}_1 = -0.552$, $\hat{\phi}_2 = -0.733$, $\hat{\theta}_1 = 0.590$, $\hat{\theta}_2 = 1.000$, constant 3.222, $\hat{\sigma}^2 = 4.031$, AICc = 206.61 (worse than part (a)'s 198.32). Forecasts 73.2, 75.6, 77.1, 77.7, 79.5, 81.3, 82.2, 83.6, 85.4, 86.6 show a mild wave pattern (complex AR roots) superimposed on an upward trend, tracking slightly below the ARIMA(0,2,1) forecasts in the long run.

Removing the constant.

```
fit_d2 <- tryCatch(
  aus_airpassengers |>
    model(arima = ARIMA(Passengers ~ 0 + pdq(2, 1, 2))),
  error = function(e) e
)
fit_d2
```

```
# A mable: 1 x 1
      arima
  <model>
1 <NULL model>
```

Without the drift term, `ARIMA()` returns a `NULL` model and reports “*non-stationary AR part from CSS*” — the conditional-sum-of-squares optimiser cannot find a stationary AR configuration for this specification, so estimation fails.

e. **ARIMA(0, 2, 1) with a constant.**

```
fit_e <- aus_airpassengers |>
  model(arima = ARIMA(Passengers ~ 1 + pdq(0, 2, 1)))
report(fit_e)
```

Series: Passengers

Model: ARIMA(0,2,1) w/ poly

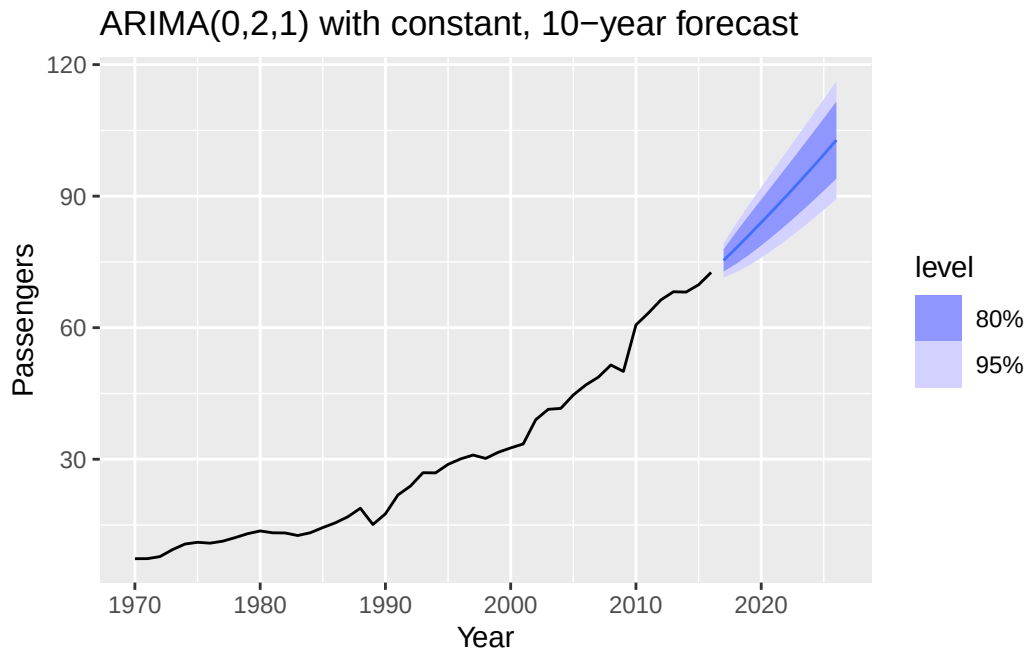
Coefficients:

	ma1	constant
	-1.0000	0.0571
s.e.	0.0585	0.0213

sigma² estimated as 3.855: log likelihood=-95.1

AIC=196.21 AICc=196.79 BIC=201.63

```
fit_e |>
  forecast(h = 10) |>
  autoplot(aus_airpassengers) +
  labs(title = "ARIMA(0,2,1) with constant, 10-year forecast")
```



ARIMA() warns that the specification induces a polynomial trend and labels the model ARIMA(0,2,1) w/ poly. With $d = 2$, a non-zero constant c means the second difference has mean c , so X_t carries a quadratic term $\frac{c}{2}t^2$. The forecasts 75.4, 78.2, 81.1, 84.0, 87.0, 90.0, 93.1, 96.3, 99.5, 103.0 have increasing year-on-year increments (2.8, 2.9, 2.9, 3.0, 3.0, 3.1, 3.1, 3.2, 3.3), i.e. curve upwards. Such quadratic extrapolation is unrealistic for air-passenger demand; the model in (a) is preferred.

2. Seasonal ARIMA

a. Load the data.

```
diabetes <- read_rds("../_data/cleaned/diabetes.rds")
head(diabetes)
```

```
# A tsibble: 6 x 3 [1M]
  Month TotalC Cost
  <mth>   <dbl> <dbl>
1 1991 Jul  3526591 3.53
2 1991 Aug  3180891 3.18
3 1991 Sep  3252221 3.25
4 1991 Oct  3611003 3.61
5 1991 Nov  3565869 3.57
6 1991 Dec  4306371 4.31
```


b. Build Y: log + seasonal difference.

```
dbt <- diabetes |> mutate(Y = difference(log(Cost), lag = 12))
```

c. KPSS test on Y.

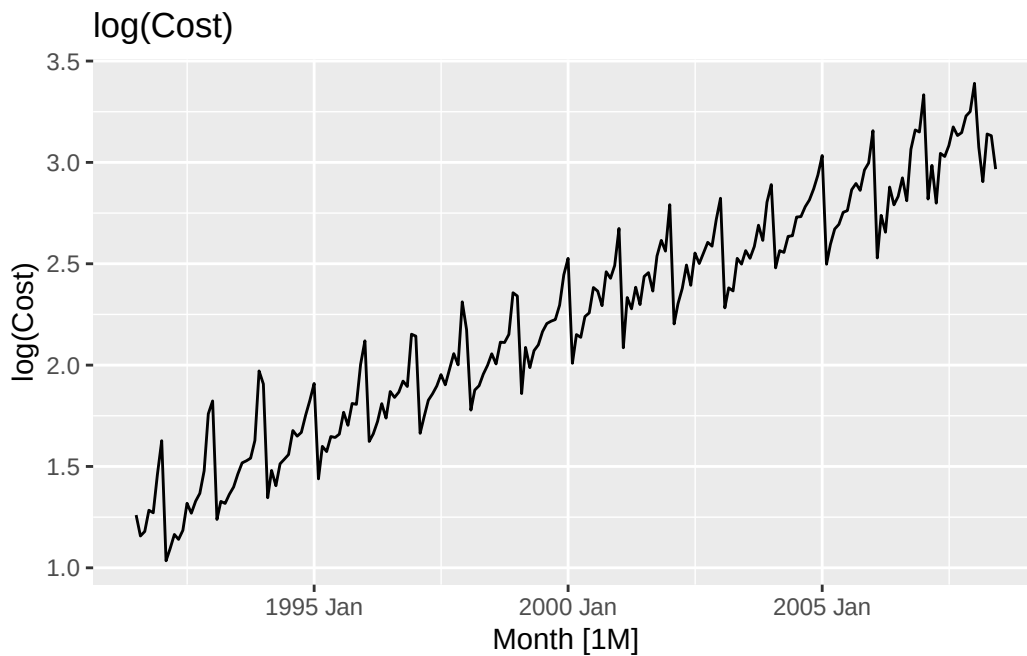
```
dbt |> features(Y, unitroot_kpss)
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 2
  kpss_stat kpss_pvalue
  <dbl>      <dbl>
1    0.209      0.1
```

The KPSS statistic is 0.209 with reported p-value 0.1 (the feasts/urca implementation caps p-values above 0.1 at 0.1). Since $p \geq 0.1 > 0.05$, we **fail to reject** the null of stationarity, so Y is consistent with a (level-)stationary series.

d. Time plot of log(Cost).

```
dbt |> autoplot(log(Cost)) +
  labs(title = "log(Cost)")
```



log(Cost) shows a clear upward trend plus a strong annual seasonal pattern. The trend disappears from Y for two reasons at once:

- If $\log(\text{Cost}_t) \approx \alpha + \beta t + s_t + u_t$ with period-12 seasonal $s_t = s_{t-12}$ and linear trend, then $Y_t = 12\beta + (u_t - u_{t-12})$, i.e. the trend collapses to the constant 12β and the seasonal component cancels out.
- More generally, a seasonal difference removes any slowly-varying component whose value at t is close to its value at $t - 12$, which is exactly the behaviour of a linear (or locally linear) trend. What is left is short-horizon variation, which KPSS does not detect as non-stationary.

e. **Fit an ARIMA model to $\log(\text{Cost})$.**

```
fit2 <- dbt |> model(arima = ARIMA(log(Cost)))
report(fit2)
```

Series: Cost

Model: ARIMA(2,0,2)(1,1,1)[12] w/ drift

Transformation: log(Cost)

Coefficients:

	ar1	ar2	ma1	ma2	sar1	sma1	constant
	0.7211	0.1081	-0.6809	0.1198	0.2236	-0.8464	0.0151
s.e.	0.2364	0.2064	0.2316	0.1752	0.1112	0.0835	0.0004

sigma^2 estimated as 0.003595: log likelihood=266.01

AIC=-516.02 AICc=-515.24 BIC=-489.96

The fitted model is **ARIMA(2,0,2)(1,1,1)₁₂ with drift**, with coefficients $\hat{\phi}_1 = 0.721$, $\hat{\phi}_2 = 0.108$, $\hat{\theta}_1 = -0.681$, $\hat{\theta}_2 = 0.120$, $\hat{\Phi}_1 = 0.224$, $\hat{\Theta}_1 = -0.846$, drift = 0.0151, $\hat{\sigma}^2 = 0.003595$, log-likelihood = 266.01, AIC = -516.02, AICc = -515.24, BIC = -489.96.

f. **Number of fitted parameters.**

```
tidy(fit2)
```

A tibble: 7 x 6

	.model	term	estimate	std.error	statistic	p.value
	<chr>	<chr>	<dbl>	<dbl>	<dbl>	<dbl>
1	arima	ar1	0.721	0.236	3.05	2.61e- 3
2	arima	ar2	0.108	0.206	0.524	6.01e- 1
3	arima	ma1	-0.681	0.232	-2.94	3.69e- 3
4	arima	ma2	0.120	0.175	0.684	4.95e- 1
5	arima	sar1	0.224	0.111	2.01	4.56e- 2
6	arima	sma1	-0.846	0.0835	-10.1	1.32e-19
7	arima	constant	0.0151	0.000426	35.4	5.43e-86

The `tidy()` output lists **7 fitted coefficients**: `ar1`, `ar2`, `ma1`, `ma2`, `sar1`, `sma1`, `constant`. If we also count the innovation variance σ^2 as a fitted parameter (which R's AIC formula does), there are $k = 8$ parameters — this matches the implied penalty because $\text{AIC} - (-2 \log L) = -516.02 + 2(266.01) = 16 = 2 \times 8$.

3. Model selection

a. Null hypothesis and assumptions of the ADF test.

The Augmented Dickey–Fuller test fits a regression of ΔX_t on X_{t-1} and lagged differences $\Delta X_{t-1}, \dots, \Delta X_{t-p}$, optionally with a constant and linear time trend. The null hypothesis is H_0 : the series has a **unit root** (is non-stationary, specifically $I(1)$), against H_1 : the series is stationary (possibly around a trend). The main assumptions are:

- The true data-generating process is a linear autoregression with i.i.d. (or at least white-noise, mean-zero, finite-variance) innovations;
- The number of lagged differences p is chosen large enough to make the residuals uncorrelated but not so large that power is lost;
- Any deterministic component (constant / trend) included in the test regression matches the deterministic structure of the data under H_1 .

b. Can ADF and KPSS both have large p-values?

Yes. The two tests have *opposite* null hypotheses — ADF tests H_0 : unit root vs KPSS tests H_0 : stationarity — so “large p-value” means *failing to reject* their respective nulls:

- Large ADF p-value $\Rightarrow$ we cannot rule out a unit root.
- Large KPSS p-value $\Rightarrow$ we cannot rule out stationarity.

Both tests can have low power in short or borderline samples (e.g. near-unit-root processes, $\phi = 0.95$), so it is entirely possible for neither test to reject. The correct interpretation then is simply that the data are not informative enough to distinguish stationarity from a unit root, and additional information (differencing + re-testing, plots, domain knowledge) should be used.

c. AIC and AICc penalties for the Q2 model.

With $k = 8$ fitted parameters (7 coefficients + σ^2) and $n = 204$ observations:

```
n <- nrow(diabetes); k <- 8
aic_penalty <- 2 * k
aicc_penalty <- 2 * k + 2 * k * (k + 1) / (n - k - 1)
c(AIC_penalty = aic_penalty, AICc_penalty = aicc_penalty)
```

AIC_penalty	AICc_penalty
16.00000	16.73846

- AIC penalty = $2k = 16$.
- AICc penalty = $2k + \frac{2k(k+1)}{n-k-1} = 16 + \frac{2 \cdot 8 \cdot 9}{204 - 8 - 1} = 16 + \frac{144}{195} \approx 16.738$.

Sanity check: $\text{AIC} - (-2 \log L) = -516.02 + 532.02 = 16\checkmark$, $\text{AICc} - \text{AIC} \approx 0.787 \approx 144/195\checkmark$.

d. **Fit an ETS model and compare.**

```
fit_both <- diabetes |>
  model(
    arima = ARIMA(log(Cost)),
    ets    = ETS(Cost)
  )
glance(fit_both) |> select(.model, log_lik, AIC, AICc, BIC)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 5
  .model log_lik  AIC  AICc  BIC
  <chr>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
1 arima    266. -516. -515. -490.
2 ets     -417.  868.  871.  924.
```

The ETS selector chooses **ETS(M, A, M)** (multiplicative error, additive trend, multiplicative seasonality). The comparison table gives

Model	log L	AICc
ARIMA(2,0,2)(1,1,1) ₁₂ w/ drift on log(Cost)	+266.01	−515.24
ETS(M, A, M) on Cost	−416.97	871.23

e. **Can we compare them via log-likelihood or AICc?**

No, not directly. The ARIMA was fit on $\log(\text{Cost})$, so its likelihood is on the log scale, while ETS(M,A,M) was fit on Cost . The change of variables introduces a Jacobian that shifts the ARIMA log-likelihood by $-\sum_t \log(\text{Cost}_t)$, which is a data-dependent constant unrelated to model fit. To compare the two, either fit them on the same scale, adjust the ARIMA log-likelihood by $-\sum_t \log(\text{Cost}_t)$, or compare out-of-sample forecast accuracy via time series cross-validation (scale-free).

4. Dynamic regression (adapted from Q10.4 in Hyndman & Athanasopoulos)

a. Inflation adjustment.

```
acc <- aus_accommodation |>
  mutate(AdjTakings = Takings / CPI * 100)
```

b. Fit a dynamic regression model for each state.

```
knot <- yearquarter("2008 Q1")
fits <- acc |>
  model(dr = ARIMA(AdjTakings ~ season() + trend(knots = knot)))
fits
```

```
# A mable: 8 x 2
# Key:      State [8]
  State                                dr
  <chr>                                <model>
1 Australian Capital Territory    <LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0) errors>
2 New South Wales                <LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0)(0,0,1)[4] errors>
3 Northern Territory             <LM w/ ARIMA(0,0,1)(1,0,0)[4] errors>
4 Queensland                    <LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0)(0,0,1)[4] errors>
5 South Australia               <LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0)(1,0,0)[4] errors>
6 Tasmania                     <LM w/ ARIMA(0,0,1)(1,0,0)[4] errors>
7 Victoria                     <LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0)(0,0,1)[4] errors>
8 Western Australia             <LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0) errors>
```

Each row shows which ARIMA error structure was chosen by `ARIMA()` state-by-state.

c. Victoria.

```
vic <- fits |> filter(State == "Victoria")
report(vic)
```

Series: AdjTakings

Model: LM w/ ARIMA(1,0,0)(0,0,1)[4] errors

Coefficients:

	ar1	sma1	season()year2	season()year3	season()year4
	0.6596	0.3756	-57.8760	-36.0249	-12.9360
s.e.	0.0866	0.1242	3.9693	4.6151	4.0447

	trend(knots = knot)trend	trend(knots = knot)trend_41	intercept
	3.1995	0.3892	264.4398
s.e.	0.4871	0.9790	13.3769

sigma^2 estimated as 170.8: log likelihood=-291.63
AIC=601.26 AICc=604.07 BIC=622

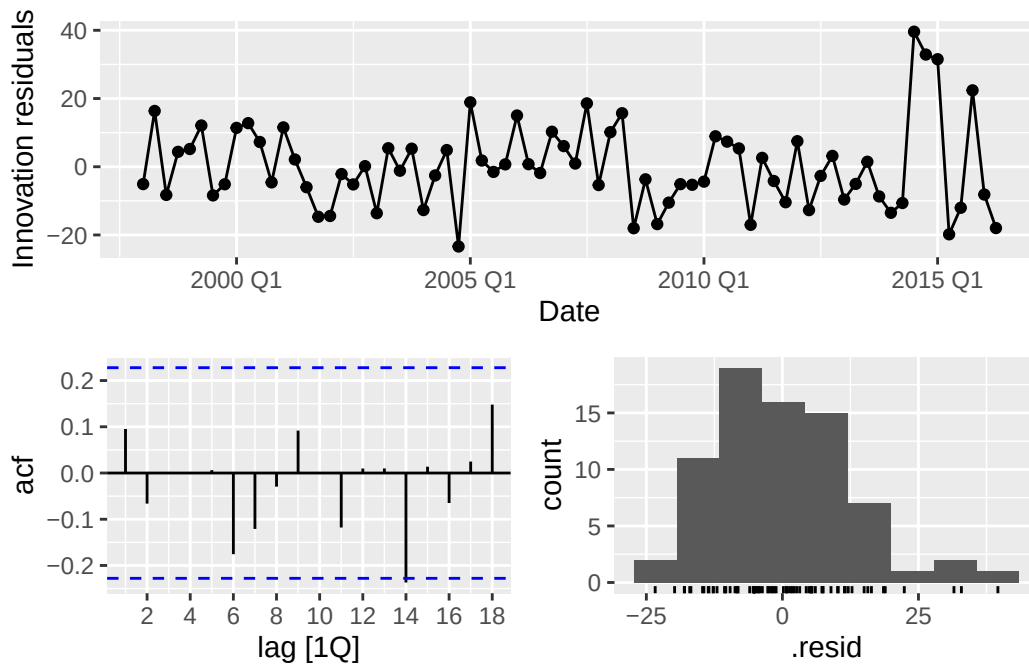
For Victoria, the fitted model is a linear regression with **ARIMA(1,0,0)(0,0,1)₄** errors. The regression part has quarterly dummies, a pre-2008 slope, and a kink at 2008 Q1:

- Intercept = 264.44;
- Seasonal dummies (Q1 is the reference level): year2 = -57.88, year3 = -36.02, year4 = -12.94 — all highly significant — so Q1 has the highest takings, followed by Q4, Q3, Q2;
- Pre-knot linear slope = 3.20 (significant, $p \approx 6 \times 10^{-9}$); the post-knot *additional* slope is 0.389 and is **not significant** ($p = 0.69$), so the trend essentially continues at the same pre-2008 rate;
- AR(1) = 0.660, SMA(1) = 0.376 (both significant, $p < 0.005$).

Is seasonality constant? The seasonal dummies impose a *deterministic, time-invariant* seasonal pattern. The significant seasonal MA(1) term ($\hat{\Theta}_1 = 0.376$, $p = 0.003$) indicates that **residual seasonal dependence remains after the fixed dummies** — the dummies alone do not fully capture the seasonal structure, and the SMA(1) component absorbs the leftover stochastic seasonal correlation.

d. Residual diagnostics for Victoria.

```
vic |> gg_tsresiduals()
```



```
vic |> augment() |> features(.innov, ljung_box, lag = 8, dof = 0)
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 4
  State    .model lb_stat lb_pvalue
  <chr>    <chr>   <dbl>   <dbl>
1 Victoria dr      4.90    0.769
```

The innovation-ACF plot shows no spike outside the significance bands and the Ljung–Box test at lag 8 gives $Q^* = 4.90$ with $p = 0.769$ — far above any reasonable significance level — so the residuals are consistent with white noise.

e. **Forecast CPI, then forecast Victoria takings to the end of 2017.**

The data ends in 2016 Q2, so we need $h = 6$ quarters (2016 Q3 through 2017 Q4).

```
# Forecast CPI separately with its own ARIMA model
cpi_ts <- acc |>
  filter(State == "Victoria") |>
  select(Date, CPI) |>
  as_tsibble(index = Date)
fit_cpi <- cpi_ts |> model(cpi_arima = ARIMA(CPI))
report(fit_cpi)
```

Series: CPI
Model: ARIMA(0,1,0) w/ drift

Coefficients:
 constant
 0.5699
s.e. 0.0520

sigma² estimated as 0.2003: log likelihood=-44.37
AIC=92.74 AICc=92.91 BIC=97.32

```
fcst_cpi <- fit_cpi |> forecast(h = 6)

# Supply forecasted CPI as new_data to the Victoria dynamic regression
new_data_vic <- new_data(acc |> filter(State == "Victoria"), 6) |>
  mutate(CPI = fcst_cpi$.mean)

fcst_adj <- vic |> forecast(new_data = new_data_vic)

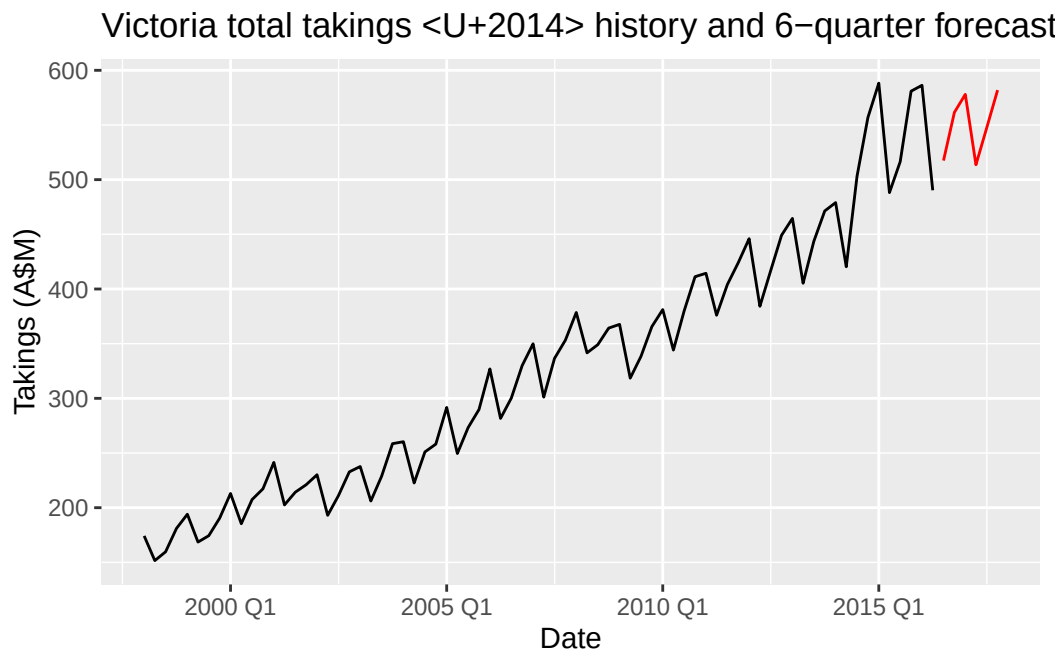
takings_fcst <- as_tibble(fcst_adj) |>
  select(Date, AdjTakings_hat = .mean) |>
  mutate(CPI = new_data_vic$CPI,
         Takings_hat = AdjTakings_hat * CPI / 100)
takings_fcst
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 4
   Date AdjTakings_hat   CPI Takings_hat
  <qtr>      <dbl> <dbl>      <dbl>
1 2016 Q3          474.  109.        517.
2 2016 Q4          512.  110.        562.
3 2017 Q1          524.  110.        578.
4 2017 Q2          463.  111.        514.
5 2017 Q3          491.  111.        547.
6 2017 Q4          519.  112.        582.
```

The CPI model chosen is **ARIMA(0,1,0) with drift** (random walk with drift $\hat{c} = 0.570$ per quarter). Plugging the point forecasts of CPI into the Victoria model and re-inflating the adjusted takings by $\widehat{\text{Takings}} = \widehat{\text{AdjTakings}} \cdot \widehat{\text{CPI}}/100$ gives:

Quarter	$\widehat{\text{AdjTakings}}$	$\widehat{\text{CPI}}$	$\widehat{\text{Takings (A\$M)}}$
2016 Q3	473.99	109.17	517.45
2016 Q4	511.67	109.74	561.50
2017 Q1	523.98	110.31	578.01
2017 Q2	463.23	110.88	513.62
2017 Q3	491.15	111.45	547.39
2017 Q4	519.47	112.02	581.90

```
acc |>
  filter(State == "Victoria") |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Date, y = Takings)) +
  geom_line() +
  geom_line(data = takings_fcst, aes(y = Takings_hat), colour = "red") +
  labs(title = "Victoria total takings - history and 6-quarter forecast",
       y = "Takings (A\$M)")
```



The forecast preserves the strong Q1-peak / Q2-trough seasonal pattern and continues the pre-2008 linear rise.

- f. **Sources of uncertainty not reflected in the prediction intervals.** The intervals shown by `forecast()` only propagate the ARIMA-error innovation variance of the Victoria model. They do **not** account for:

- **Uncertainty in the CPI forecast.** We plugged in the point forecasts $\widehat{\text{CPI}}$ as known covariates, so the variability coming from the CPI ARIMA model (and from re-inflating by a multiplicative, noisy CPI) is ignored.
- **Parameter estimation uncertainty** of the Victoria dynamic regression (coefficients on dummies, trend and the ARIMA parameters are treated as known at their point estimates).
- **Model uncertainty / specification risk:** we assumed one knot at 2008 Q1, a piecewise-linear trend, four deterministic seasonal dummies, and an ARIMA(1,0,0)(0,0,1)₄ error process. Any of these choices could be wrong, and the intervals do not widen to reflect that.

5. State space models

Consider

$$T_t = T_{t-1} + \epsilon_t, \quad S_t = 0.8 S_{t-4} + \eta_t, \quad Y_t = T_t + S_t + V_t,$$

with $\epsilon_t \sim WN(0, \sigma_1^2)$, $\eta_t \sim WN(0, \sigma_2^2)$, $V_t \sim WN(0, \sigma_3^2)$, mutually uncorrelated.

a. Linear Gaussian state space form.

Because S_t depends on S_{t-4} , we must keep three extra lags in the state. Let

$$\mathbf{X}_t = (T_t, S_t, S_{t-1}, S_{t-2}, S_{t-3})^\top \in \mathbb{R}^5.$$

Then

$$\mathbf{X}_t = F \mathbf{X}_{t-1} + \mathbf{w}_t, \quad Y_t = H \mathbf{X}_t + V_t,$$

with

$$F = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0.8 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{w}_t = \begin{pmatrix} \epsilon_t \\ \eta_t \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad Q = \text{Cov}(\mathbf{w}_t) = \text{diag}(\sigma_1^2, \sigma_2^2, 0, 0, 0),$$

and

$$H = (1 \quad 1 \quad 0 \quad 0 \quad 0), \quad R = \text{Var}(V_t) = \sigma_3^2.$$

Verification: row 1 of $F\mathbf{X}_{t-1} + \mathbf{w}_t$ gives $T_{t-1} + \epsilon_t = T_t$; row 2 gives $0.8 S_{t-4} + \eta_t = S_t$ (using that the 5-th entry of $\mathbf{X}_{t-1}$ is S_{t-4}); rows 3–5 simply shift $S_{t-1}, S_{t-2}, S_{t-3}$ down one lag. And $H\mathbf{X}_t = T_t + S_t$, so $H\mathbf{X}_t + V_t = Y_t$.

b. Does $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \text{Var}(S_t - \hat{S}_{t|n})$ exist?

Interpreting $\hat{S}_{t|n}$ as the optimal (MSE-minimising) predictor given $Y_{1:n}$ with n fixed and $t \rightarrow \infty$, we are asking about long-horizon forecast error for the seasonal component. Since $|0.8| < 1$, the process $S_t = 0.8S_{t-4} + \eta_t$ is a causal stationary AR process (an AR(1) in the lag-4 operator) with

$$\gamma_S(0) = \text{Var}(S_t) = \frac{\sigma_2^2}{1 - 0.8^2} = \frac{\sigma_2^2}{0.36}.$$

As the forecast horizon $h = t - n \rightarrow \infty$, $\hat{S}_{t|n} \rightarrow E[S_t] = 0$ and the forecast error variance approaches the unconditional variance. So the limit **does exist** and

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \text{Var}(S_t - \hat{S}_{t|n}) = \gamma_S(0) = \frac{\sigma_2^2}{1 - 0.8^2} = \frac{\sigma_2^2}{0.36} = \frac{25\sigma_2^2}{9}.$$

c. **Does** $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \text{Var}(T_t - \hat{T}_{t|n})$ **exist**?

T_t is a random walk, so $T_t = T_n + \sum_{k=n+1}^t \epsilon_k$ for $t > n$. The best predictor given $Y_{1:n}$ is $\hat{T}_{t|n} = \hat{T}_{n|n}$ (a random walk's forecast is flat), so

$$\text{Var}(T_t - \hat{T}_{t|n}) = \text{Var}(T_n - \hat{T}_{n|n}) + (t - n) \sigma_1^2.$$

As $t \rightarrow \infty$ the second term diverges linearly, so the limit **does not exist** (it is $+\infty$). This reflects the familiar fact that long-run forecasts of a random walk have unbounded uncertainty, while the stationary seasonal component's forecast uncertainty is bounded by its marginal variance.